

grep / egrep Commands – Practical Linux Notes

What is grep?

- grep stands for **Global Regular Expression Print**
- Used to **search text line-by-line** and print lines that **match a pattern**
- Works with:
 - Files
 - Command output (via pipes)

👉 grep **filters lines**, it does NOT modify text.

Basic grep Syntax

```
grep [options] pattern file
```

- **pattern** → word or regex to search
- **file** → input file (optional if using pipe)

Check grep Version or Help

```
grep --version
```

```
grep --help
```

✓ Shows version or help info

Search for a Keyword in a File

```
grep keyword file
```

✓ Prints all lines containing keyword

Count Matching Lines

```
grep -c keyword file
```

✓ Counts number of lines that contain keyword

Case-Insensitive Search

```
grep -i KEYword file
```

✓ Matches:

- keyword
 - KEYWORD
 - KeyWord
- (case doesn't matter)

Show Line Numbers

```
grep -n keyword file
```

✓ Prints:

- Matching lines
- Their **line numbers**

Invert Match (Exclude Keyword)

```
grep -v keyword file
```

✓ Prints **all lines except** those containing keyword

Combine grep with awk

```
grep keyword file | awk '{print $1}'
```

✓ Steps:

1. grep filters matching lines
2. awk prints **1st field only**

Very common in real usage 🔥

grep with Command Output

```
ls -l | grep Desktop
```

✓ Shows only ls -l entries containing **Desktop**

What is egrep?

- egrep = **extended grep**
- Supports **extended regular expressions**
- (Same as grep -E in modern Linux)

Search for Multiple Keywords (OR condition)

```
egrep -i "keyword|keyword2" file
```

✓ Matches:

- keyword **OR**
 - keyword2
- (case-insensitive)

Equivalent modern command:

```
grep -Ei "keyword|keyword2" file
```

Common grep Options (Quick Table)

Option	Meaning
-c	Count matching lines
-i	Ignore case
-n	Show line numbers
-v	Invert match
-E	Extended regex (egrep)
-r	Recursive search
-w	Match whole word